

Salesforce Foundational Rules — Template

Purpose: This file is the knowledge layer for Claude (and any teammate) when building or updating any Salesforce-connected artifact — dashboards, analyzers, command centers, pipeline tools. It defines which records matter, how fields should be interpreted, how to handle edge cases, and what rules must be followed so every tool produces consistent, trustworthy output. This is a **decision manual**, not just a data dictionary — when in doubt about how to interpret ambiguous data, check here first.

How to use this template: Walk your new org's Salesforce instance section by section and replace every [BRACKETED] placeholder with the real values. The structure is the valuable part — it forces you to lock down the decisions that, left ambiguous, produce inconsistent dashboards and broken automations. Fill it out *before* you build tooling on top, and keep it as the single reference every Claude session loads.

Last updated: [DATE] (v1 — initial setup at new org)

Owner: [YOUR NAME] & [DATA/REVOPS PARTNER]

Usage: Load this file as a reference in every Claude session that touches Salesforce data. It is the persistent knowledge layer, not a one-off document. Anyone building Salesforce-connected artifacts should have it in their workspace so all tools share one definition of "correct."

0. First-week discovery (do this before filling anything in)

You cannot write good foundational rules until you know the org. Run these against the new instance first:

- **Inventory record types** on Opportunity (and Lead/Account if relevant): `SELECT Id, Name, SubjectType FROM RecordType`.
- **Inventory custom fields** and their API names: use Setup → Object Manager, or describe the object. Note which are formula fields, which are picklists, which are free-text.
- **Pull the stage list:** `SELECT StageName, COUNT(Id) FROM Opportunity GROUP BY StageName`.

- **Pull the owner list:** `SELECT Owner.Name, COUNT(Id) FROM Opportunity WHERE IsClosed = false GROUP BY Owner.Name.`
- **Identify the currency setup:** is multi-currency enabled? Which field holds the recurring revenue number? Is there a converted/USD field?
- **Find the duplicates and the free-text fields** — those are your hygiene risks.

Everything below is where you record the answers.

1. Record Type Filter

Rule: Decide which record type(s) your pipeline tools should default to, and document why the others are excluded. Filtering to the right record type is the single most important consistency rule — get it wrong and every downstream number is wrong.

Record Type	ID	Include?	Notes
[PRIMARY RECORD TYPE]	[ID]	YES — primary	[What this represents — e.g., current new-business book]
[SECONDARY]	[ID]	Conditional	[When to include]
[OTHER]	[ID]	No	[Why excluded — different product line / buyer motion]

SOQL pattern:

```
SQL
WHERE [RecordTypeFilterField] = '[VALUE]'
```

Field: Prefer a readable formula field that returns the record type *name* (e.g., a `Record_Type_Name__c`-style field) over filtering on raw `RecordTypeId`, so queries and filters are human-readable and survive sandbox refreshes (IDs differ across orgs; names don't).

Why this matters for hygiene: Record type IDs are org-specific and change between sandboxes and production. Build every tool against a name-based filter, never a hardcoded ID, or your tools break on deployment.

2. Currency & Revenue Fields

Document which field is the source of truth for recurring revenue, and how to handle multiple currencies.

Multi-currency? [YES / NO]. If yes, list the currencies: [USD, ...].

Field	Label	Use When
[PRIMARY ARR FIELD]	[label]	Primary recurring-revenue field. [Native or converted?]
<code>convertCurrency([ARR FIELD]) arrUSD</code>	ARR (converted)	For cross-deal comparison if multi-currency is on. The <code>convertCurrency()</code> SOQL function returns the org's converted value.
<code>CurrencyIsoCode</code>	Currency	Display alongside native values so readers know the denomination.
[ANY DEPRECATED FIELD]	—	DEPRECATED — do not use. [Reason]

Fallback chain for revenue display: [converted] → [native] → 0

For pipeline totals / cross-owner comparison: Always use the converted value so currencies are comparable. **For individual deal cards:** Show converted + native with the ISO code, e.g., "\$1.2M USD (CAD \$1.6M)".

Non-recurring / services revenue

List any one-time, implementation, services, platform-fee, or variable-fee fields here so "total revenue" is unambiguous:

Field	Label	Notes
[SERVICE FEE FIELD]	[label]	[One-time vs ongoing]

Define "total revenue" explicitly: [e.g., recurring ARR + one-time services]. Recurring and one-time should never be silently summed into a pipeline number — keep them as separate line items.

Cowork / artifact technical note

MCP wrappers return Salesforce responses in varying shapes. Any artifact should normalize through a single parse helper rather than reading `res.records` directly:

```
JavaScript
function parseResponse(r) {
  if (!r) return [];
  if (r.records) return r.records;
  if (r.content) {
    let txt = r.content;
    if (typeof txt === 'object' && txt.text) txt = txt.text;
    if (Array.isArray(txt)) txt = txt.map(t => t.text || '').join('');
    if (typeof txt === 'string') {
      const parsed = JSON.parse(txt);
      return parsed.records || [];
    }
  }
  return [];
}
```

3. Opportunity Type (origination)

Document how the `Type` field (or equivalent) distinguishes how a deal originated, and which values count as new business vs. renewal/expansion/adjustment.

Type Value	Category	Include in Pipeline Analysis?
[Direct/New]	New business	YES
[Upsell]	Expansion	YES — but filterable
[Renewal]	Renewal	Conditional — not new pipeline
[Adjustment/True-up]	Adjustment	Usually exclude

Type Value	Category	Include in Pipeline Analysis?
[Services]	Services	Usually exclude

Recommended filter: Toggle between "All Types", "New Business Only", and "[Expansion] Only".

4. Pipeline Category (early / mid / late stage)

This is almost always a **derived categorization** — there's usually no single field for it. Map it from stage so every tool groups the funnel identically.

Category	Stages Included	Meaning
[Early / Pre-Qualified]	[stages]	Not yet qualified.
[Qualified]	[stages]	Active evaluation, validated need.
[Late / Commercial]	[stages]	Commercial conversation underway, heading to close.

Implementation: Derive from `StageName` at render time. Expose as a filter pill.

Unmapped stages

Stage	Handling	Rationale
[Parking/Nurture stage]	Exclude from active pipeline. Show in a separate "parked" bucket if at all.	Parked deals inflate pipeline totals and distort velocity.
Closed Won	Win-rate / historical analysis only.	The destination, not a pipeline stage.
Closed Lost	Loss analysis only.	Same.

Rule for Claude: If a stage doesn't map to a category and isn't Closed Won/Lost, treat it as unmapped — log a data-quality warning rather than guessing.

5. Owner / Seller Scope & Inclusion Rules

Define who counts as pipeline-carrying, and who is excluded from seller analysis. **Capture roles, not just names** — names churn, roles persist. (Avoid pasting a static name list you'll have to maintain; prefer deriving owners from query data and tagging by role.)

Role	Include in IC pipeline?	Include in closed/historical?	Notes
Individual contributor sellers	YES	YES	Core new-business pipeline.
Account managers	[YES/NO]	[YES/NO]	[Do they carry pipeline that affects org totals?]
Former employees	Exclude from active	In closed analysis	Their deals resolved after departure; excluding creates win/loss gaps.
CSM / Leadership / Partnerships	Exclude	Org-wide views only if requested	Own deals for non-sales reasons.

Inclusion matrix

View Type	IC Sellers	AMs	Former Employees	CSM/Leadership
Org-wide command center	YES	[?]	In closed analysis	Exclude
History analyzer	YES	[?]	YES	Exclude
Individual command centers	Owner-specific	N/A	N/A	N/A

Default-view rule: Decide whether the default view applies role-based exclusions or shows all owners. Document the decision so it isn't silently re-litigated in every tool.

6. Deal Health Definitions

Display these **front and center** on any dashboard that uses health categorization, so stakeholders can adjust thresholds without code changes.

Status	Definition	Visual
STALLED	No logged activity for [X]+ days OR [Y]+ days past close date OR days in stage exceeds [Z] × the stage benchmark	Red
AT RISK	No logged activity for [X1-X2] days OR past close (under [Y] days) OR approaching stage benchmark	Amber
ON TRACK	Recent activity within [X1] days AND within stage benchmark AND close date is future	Green

Caveats to display alongside

- Activity dates reflect **CRM-logged activity only**. Sellers who work in email/Slack/phone may be engaged without it showing in Salesforce — caveat all activity-based signals with "per SF."
 - Compute stage benchmarks dynamically (won + open deals, excluding losses so fast-death deals don't drag benchmarks down) — or set explicit numeric thresholds with the team.
 - Close dates are frequently optimistic; past-close is common. Don't escalate to STALLED unless well overdue.
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7. Cohorting & Time Periods

Cohort deals by: `[CreatedDate / open date]` rather than legacy labels. The record-type filter (Section 1) should already separate eras, so open date gives cleaner longitudinal analysis.

Recommended cohort periods: by quarter, half-year, and year (year matters for long enterprise cycles).

Time scoping for closed deals (by close date): YTD (default), last 12 / 6 months, this quarter, all-time-since-`[DATE]`.

Open deals are always included regardless of time scope.

8. Key Filter Fields

The fields every tool should expose as filter pills/dropdowns. Mark each Must / Should / Nice-to-have.

Filter	Field	Values	Priority
Record Type	<code>[field]</code>	[default]	Must
Opportunity Type	<code>Type</code>	[values]	Must
Segment / vertical	<code>[field]</code>	[values]	Must
Country/Region	<code>[field]</code>	[free-text? derive from data]	Should
Solution / product	<code>[field]</code>	[values]	Nice
Pipeline Category	derived from StageName	[categories]	Must
Owner	<code>Owner.Name</code>	derive from data	Must

Hygiene note: For any free-text field, derive the filter dropdown from the actual query results rather than hardcoding values — free-text fields drift ("US" / "USA" / "United States") and a hardcoded list will silently miss records.

9. Stage Progression Model

Document the canonical stage order and the date fields that timestamp entry into each stage (needed for velocity analysis).

None

[Stage 1] → [Stage 2] → [Stage 3] → ... → Closed Won

[Parking stage] is not part of the linear progression.

Stage	Entry Date Field
[Stage 1]	[date field]
[Stage 2]	[date field]
...	...

If the org doesn't have per-stage date fields, note it — velocity analysis will need `OpportunityFieldHistory` instead, which is heavier to query.

10. SOQL Query Template (recommended base)

Start every new artifact from one canonical SELECT so all tools pull the same shape. Fill in your real field names:

SQL

```
SELECT Id, Name, StageName,
       [ARR_FIELD], CurrencyIsoCode,
       [SERVICE_FEE_FIELDS],
       CloseDate, CreatedDate, LastActivityDate,
       Account.Name, Owner.Name,
       [RECORD_TYPE_NAME_FIELD], Type, [SEGMENT_FIELD], [REGION_FIELD],
       [STAGE_DATE_FIELDS],
       IsClosed, IsWon, NextStep, [REASON_LOST_FIELD]
FROM Opportunity
WHERE [RECORD_TYPE_FILTER]
ORDER BY CreatedDate DESC
```

Common additional filters:

- Open pipeline: `AND IsClosed = false`
- Closed deals: `AND IsClosed = true AND CreatedDate >= [DATE]`
- Specific owner: `AND Owner.Name = '[NAME]'`

NextStep as a hygiene signal: an empty `NextStep` on an open deal often means the deal is stale or unmaintained. Use it alongside `LastActivityDate` in health scoring.

11. Validation Protocol

Before building any new artifact, run these to confirm the foundational rules produce correct output. Cross-check counts against the org's native Salesforce reports.

SQL

```
-- Test 1: Record type filter returns the expected book
SELECT COUNT(Id) FROM Opportunity WHERE [RECORD_TYPE_FILTER];

-- Test 2: Owner scope – right people appear, excluded roles don't
SELECT Owner.Name, COUNT(Id) cnt FROM Opportunity
WHERE [RECORD_TYPE_FILTER] AND IsClosed = false
GROUP BY Owner.Name ORDER BY cnt DESC;

-- Test 3: Currency conversion populates on non-base-currency deals
SELECT Name, [ARR_FIELD], CurrencyIsoCode FROM Opportunity
WHERE [RECORD_TYPE_FILTER] AND CurrencyIsoCode != '[BASE]' AND IsClosed = false
LIMIT 5;

-- Test 4: Every open-deal stage maps to a pipeline category
SELECT StageName, COUNT(Id) cnt FROM Opportunity
WHERE [RECORD_TYPE_FILTER] AND IsClosed = false
GROUP BY StageName ORDER BY StageName;

-- Test 5: Service-fee fields are actually populated
SELECT Name, [SERVICE_FEE_FIELD] FROM Opportunity
WHERE [RECORD_TYPE_FILTER] AND [SERVICE_FEE_FIELD] > 0 LIMIT 5;
```

When to run: before every new artifact build, and after any change to these foundational rules.

The principle (from the original build): *get the foundation validated first, then build on top of it*. Test simple dashboards against native SF reports to confirm the numbers match before trusting anything fancier.

12. Reason-Lost Taxonomy

Document the [Reason_Lost] picklist and classify each value, because win/loss analysis is meaningless without separating real losses from administrative closures.

Real sales outcomes (include in win/loss analysis)

Value	Interpretation
[Budget/pricing]	Lost on economics
[Product/tech fit]	Capability gap
[Legal/procurement]	Killed in process
[Timing/deprioritized]	Not now — may resurface
[No response]	Went dark
[Competitive loss]	Lost in evaluation

Hygiene / not real losses (EXCLUDE from win/loss analysis)

Value	Interpretation
[Data hygiene / cleanup]	Administrative closure
[Disqualified]	Never belonged in pipeline
[Meeting never ran]	Discovery never happened
[Other]	Ambiguous — inspect manually

Hygiene filter rule: Exclude administrative-closure reasons from all win-rate and loss-pattern analysis. Note any archived/legacy reason fields and when to consult them.

13. Win-Rate Attribution Rules

The problem: When sellers inherit territories, they inherit open deals created by predecessors. If those are later closed-lost during cleanup, they unfairly count against the inheriting seller's win rate.

For org-wide metrics: use raw `Owner.Name` at query time — ownership transitions wash out at the aggregate level.

For individual seller metrics:

1. **Inherited-deal detection:** flag a deal as inherited if its `CreatedDate` predates the seller's tenure (approximate via their earliest created deal).
2. **Inherited + hygiene-closed:** exclude entirely — cleanup, not performance.
3. **Inherited + real loss:** include but flag "inherited" so viewers can adjust.
4. **Inherited + won:** include fully — they get the credit.

Always display: "Win rates include deals created before the seller's tenure. Filter to deals created in the current selling year for a cleaner read of individual performance."

14. Edge-Case Rules

Every rule here exists because the default (no rule) produces misleading output. Adapt thresholds to your org.

Deals with \$0 recurring revenue

- *Open, \$0:* data gap, not a \$0 deal — count in deal/stage counts, exclude from revenue totals, flag "Missing ARR."
- *Closed-Won, \$0:* rare but real (strategic/service-only/data miss) — count as a win, exclude from average deal size, flag for review.
- *Closed-Lost, \$0:* count in loss counts, exclude from revenue-weighted analysis.

Ownership transitions

- Salesforce stores only the current owner; history needs `OpportunityFieldHistory`. Attribute to current owner and note the limitation.
- Former employee owning open deals = data-quality issue; flag, don't attribute to an active seller.

Closed-Lost then reopened

- If `IsClosed = false` AND `[Reason_Lost]` is not null, the deal was reopened — treat as active but flag "Reopened — previously lost."

Duplicate opportunities on one account

- Multiple open opps per account are normal (different solutions/buying teams). Don't dedupe by account.
- *Exception:* same account + same solution + similar value + created within ~7 days = possible duplicate; flag.

Deals past close date

- 1–30 days: AT RISK (update close date). 31–60: AT RISK escalated. 60+: STALLED.
 - *Exception:* if `LastActivityDate` is within ~14 days, downgrade severity one level.
-

15. Data-Quality Notes

Record the known quirks of *this* org so tools caveat appropriately:

- **Activity logging is uneven** — caveat activity-based signals with "per SF."
 - **Close dates are aspirational** — treat past-close as a warning, not an emergency, unless well overdue.
 - **Stage regressions happen** — use the latest stage date, not the highest stage index, for stage-at-death.
 - **Historical data may use older stage models** — note the cutoff date for clean analysis.
 - **SOQL limits** — queries cap at 2,000 records per call; batch large pulls and warn if any batch hits exactly 2,000 (possible truncation).
 - **Free-text fields drift** — derive filter options from data, not hardcoded lists.
 - **Parking-stage deals are paused, not dead** — keep them out of active pipeline and velocity metrics.
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16. Open Questions (unresolved design decisions)

Park genuinely undecided interpretation questions here. Claude should NOT assume on these — flag them when they affect output.

1. **Total-value definition:** recurring only, or recurring + services? Likely context-dependent (pipeline review vs. total contract value) — *ask before aggregating*.
 2. **Stage-duration benchmarks:** median vs. mean, which deals to include, outlier handling — confirm before presenting as authoritative.
 3. **Write-back priorities (if/when built):** which fields to suggest updates for first (NextStep, CloseDate, Stage)?
 4. **AM vs. IC reporting:** group them or break them out visually?
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Foundations first, hygiene always. Lock these decisions down before building tooling, validate against native reports, and every dashboard, analyzer, and automation you build on top will stay consistent and trustworthy.